

Bylaws For Fits Like A Glove

Name:

The name of the Organization is Fits Like A Glove (F.L.A.G.) chartered under the laws of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts.

Purpose:

Fits Like A Glove is a social organization made up of individuals regardless of race, color, religion, national origin, sex, sexual orientation, gender identity/expression, or disability who enjoy wearing, admiring, using and celebrating gloves, leather and uniforms in many aspects of their lives. The organization exists to promote interaction between its members and will remain a social and fundraising group in its constitution.

Membership:

All members may belong to any other social or fetish organization.

Types and Qualifications:

Active Members: Must be at least 21 years of age and in compliance with the Bylaws. Individuals are strongly encouraged to attend meetings and are eligible to offer feedback and to vote on any matter concerning the organization when presented to them for consideration. Active Members are also strongly encouraged to participate in all FLAG events. Active Members will receive complimentary promotional merchandise when available. All new members are considered to be Active Members for their first year of membership. Title Holders are lifetime active members with all the rights of active members. Title Holders may choose to pay dues but are not required to do so.

Associate Members: Must be at least 21 years of age and in compliance with the Bylaws. Individuals maintain participation in FLAG through correspondence, mailing and participation in meetings and events whenever possible. Associate Membership is intended for those who already have club/organization affiliations. Associate Members are eligible to offer feedback on any matter concerning the organization but are ineligible to vote on such matters.

Honorary Members: Must be at least 21 years of age. Honorary Membership is an invitational category recognizing significant contributions by individuals to the organization. An Honorary Member is exempt from dues for a period of one (1) year. Honorary Membership can be extended at the discretion of the President/Board. An Honorary Member does not have voting privileges. They can become an Active Member or Associate Member at their own discretion.

Privileges Of Membership:

All members are entitled to attend all meetings and social events of the organization. They may receive publications via mail, email, social media, and/or the website. They can be identified as a member of FLAG, wear the club colors as designated, and be identified on membership lists.

Active Members are entitled to:

- Serve as Officers of the organization and nominate Board Members.
- Vote on all issues brought to their attention.
- Nominate individuals for Honorary Membership.
- Discounts on merchandise when available and offered to them, such as gloves, patches, T-shirts, pins, etc.
- Access to membership lists and other such internet access provided for members only when available.

Membership Applications:

Applications for membership are available on FLAG's website or social media and can be provided upon request by any officer. Applications should be returned, along with dues, to any Officer and turned over to the Treasurer. If the application is denied, the dues will be returned to the applicant.

Final membership approval is determined solely on the discretion of the President/Board.

Organization:

Board of Directors:

Organization of Fits Like A Glove (F.L.A.G.): FLAG will be governed by an appointed Board of Directors consisting of a President, Vice President,

Executive Secretary, Treasurer, and one member of the Executive Council as needed.

Executive Council:

The Executive Council guides and directs all Officers in fulfilling their duties. The Executive Council consists of: President, Vice President, Treasurer, Executive Secretary, Assistant Treasurer, Assistant Secretary, Road Captain, Merchandiser, Webmaster, Financial Advisor, and any Active Member that the Board appoints.

If deemed necessary, general and special committees may be formed by the Board. The Board will appoint members of any committee.

All members of the Board of Directors/Executive Council have one vote only, even if they hold more than one office. All Officers are appointed by the Board and will serve their term for an indefinite amount of time. All Officers are members of FLAG in good standing with the Bylaws.

The Officers and their duties consist of the following:

President: Will direct the organization. The President's duties will be to provide leadership at meetings and events, provide specific agendas and proposals for the organization, and act as liaison between FLAG and all other clubs and organizations. All decisions concerning the organization are subject to final approval of the President in consultation with the Board of Directors.

Vice President: Will serve as an assistant to the President in the direction and functioning of the organization. The Vice President will be directed by the President to set up club events, club runs, and be a spokesperson for FLAG when the President is not available, or when instructed to do so. The Vice President will continue FLAG operations should the President resign, die, or become absent.

Executive Secretary: Will assist the President in all mailings, creation of lists, and other duties as needed. The Secretary will be responsible for taking the minutes of both the meetings of the Board of Directors and the

General Membership as established in these Bylaws. The Secretary will provide a copy of the Bylaws and minutes to all the members upon request.

Treasurer: Will direct and control all aspects of this organization's finances, subject to the approval of the Board of Directors. The Treasurer will keep a ledger of all receipts and expenditures of the organization. The Treasurer will collect membership dues and all other revenue and deposit them in the organization's bank account. The Treasurer will notify members of delinquent dues.

Road Captain: Will assist at FLAG Events, assist in producing and distributing flyers for FLAG related events, be responsible for ensuring that club/bar/organization web sites and calendars are updated with FLAG event information, contact members about all upcoming events via e-mail and/or regular mail, coordinate staffing at all FLAG events (i.e. assign members for raffle, table coverage, setting up runs/events) at the discretion of the President/Board. The Road Captain will work closely with the Title Holder to ensure they are upholding their responsibilities.

Merchandiser: Will be responsible for all products of FLAG for its members (e.g. T-shirts, patches, pins, gloves, etc.). The Merchandiser will be directed by the Board to get estimates, order, and produce FLAG items.

Webmaster: Will be responsible for the timely updating of FLAG's web site, tracking the domain registration and hosting information, and notifying the President/Board of upcoming due dates. The Webmaster will provide help to members with web site issues, as well as create forms and special pages as directed by President/Board.

Assistant Secretary: Will assist the Executive Secretary in all duties assigned, according to the discretion of the Board. (Position would be filled as needed.)

Assistant Treasurer: Will assist the Treasurer in all duties assigned, according to the discretion of the Board. (Position would be filled as needed.)

Financial Advisor: Will provide financial advice to the President as well as handle tax and accounting issues in conjunction with the Treasurer. (Position would be filled as needed.)

Meetings:

There will be meetings of this organization and its Board of Directors under the following provisions.

General meetings of all members of FLAG and its Board of Directors will be called by the Vice President and held **monthly** or as needed. The dates of which will be determined by the Board of Directors at the discretion of the President.

(Do you want the monthly meetings to be in the bylaws? Meeting agenda sent to members in advance?)

Meetings of the Executive Council will be called by the Vice President and held as needed, to be determined by the President. The President may appoint a Parliamentarian (??) as needed. The February meeting will be considered the annual meeting wherein an accounting of all activities and finances will be presented by the Board of Directors to the Members (moved from previous paragraph).

Member Conduct:

In meetings, all members must be respectful of each other, listen to each other, actively participate, be non-judgmental, etc. Any member not in compliance will be dismissed from the meeting by the president. At all events, gloves will be considered proper attire for members of FLAG. While wearing the FLAG colors at events, the same code of conduct should be adhered to. (To be edited more)

Activities:

FLAG plans to hold events as needed. Also, at these club nights, **fundraising** will be held for FLAG, as well as charitable organizations **organized by the current title holder**. All members should participate **in** and contribute **to** these events in any way possible to help guarantee their success.

Annually, FLAG will hold an anniversary party, Mr/Ms/Mx FLAG Contest and cookout event. Dates will be determined by the Board of Directors. Attendance **at** these events is strongly requested as these are the three most important events held by FLAG.

Participation by Members in events sponsored by other organizations is encouraged, but the member shall not present himself as an official representative of FLAG without consent of the President and/or the Board of Directors. **(Reword – member should adhere to code of conduct)**

Finances:

The Fiscal Year begins on the first day of January and ends on the thirty-first day of December of the same year.

The books of account will be kept by the Treasurer. The Executive Council **(board?)** is responsible for auditing the books annually at the beginning of the fiscal year.

All expenditures of money must be approved by the President or the Vice President.

(Approved by the board by a vote?)

Any expenditures paid by check must be signed by the Treasurer, President, or Vice President.

Dues and Fees:

All **initial** membership **dues** are twenty-five dollars (\$25.00 US funds only) for USA residents, Thirty dollars (\$30.00 US funds) for Canadian Residents, thirty-five dollars (\$35.00 US funds) for all other international residents.

After one year of membership:

USA members: twenty dollars (\$20.00 US) annually.

Canadian members: twenty-five dollars (\$25.00 US) annually.

International members: thirty dollars (\$30.00 US) annually.

The Dues Year for the organization **begins** on the first day of January and **ends** on the thirty-first day of December of the same year. Dues are paid annually by members on the month of initial membership.

(Change to bi-yearly? Reword, discuss how and when)

If any member, with the exception of honorary members, falls delinquent in dues, the Treasurer will notify the member of their status in writing. If any member, with the exception of honorary members, is delinquent four (4) months past the date of initial membership, **the member will be terminated**. Special exclusions may be granted by the Board of Directors.

Dissolution:

In the event of dissolution, all physical property of the organization shall be considered the personal property of the Founder of the organization James B Maciel Jr. All available cash assets shall be used to discharge any remaining indebtedness and then redistributed to members who joined within three (3) months of the dissolution. Any cash left over will **be** donated to a registered charity decided on by the Board of Directors.

In the event of dissolution, all records, membership lists, financial records, etc. will be destroyed by the Treasurer and Secretary **except** those required and protected by local, State, or Federal laws.

Logos Emblems and Banners:

The organization Logos, Emblems, and Banners are property of the Organization.

The Logos, Emblems, and Banner may not be duplicated by anyone without expressed written permission by the Founder of the Organization James B Maciel Jr.

The Organization emblem/logo may only be worn or displayed by individual members of the Organization, or by supporters of the organization. (i.e. T-shirts, patches, pins).

Emblems, logos, and banners are held in the responsibility and the **shared** possession of the President and **Merchandiser**.

Grievance, Cancellations, and Incidents:

Submit any grievances about the Organization or Executive Council (board?) member verbally or in writing to any member of the Executive Council (board?) for presentation at the next General or Executive Council (board?) meetings.

Cancellations must be presented in writing to the Board of Directors

All incidents must be reported to the President, Board of Directors, or Executive Council within (# of hours).

The President, Board of Directors, and/or Executive Council will respond within (# of days) to all grievances, cancellations, and incidents.

Grievances about board members.

Disciplinary actions, suspensions, etc.

(How will these be addressed, more detail needed.)

Amendments to the Bylaws:

Any Member may submit a proposed amendment(s) with justification to the Bylaws to the Executive Council. The Executive Council will submit in writing any proposed amendment(s) with a justification for the amendment(s) to the Membership at the next General or Executive Council meeting. After such presentation, the proposed amendment shall become a part of the By-laws if approved unanimously by the current members in attendance at the meeting.